

copy of the text in 1894⁵⁶⁷ read *u TUR* = *u mâru* instead of the *û* of Pinches and the *DAM* = *aššatu* of Winckler. The most recent copy and interpretation of the text were published by Sidney Smith in 1924.⁵⁶⁸ He represents line 23 as beginning with cuneiform wedges which may be regarded as part of a mutilated *DAM*.⁵⁶⁹ His comment is as follows: "The traces favor Pinches' reading *DAM*. Hagen's reading is impossible, though Pinches accepted it; see Craig Robinson, *The Fall of Babylon*, p. 14 (a paper read before the Victoria Institute)." ⁵⁷⁰ Smith translates: "(the wife) of the king died," ⁵⁷¹ thus favoring the interpretation of Winckler and Schrader. The writer would state, after an examination of the tablet itself in the British Museum, that the traces which remain of the original cuneiform sign or signs at the beginning of line 23 are not sufficiently legible for decisive conclusion as to what the scribe actually wrote. The discovery of an un mutilated duplicate of the text can alone settle the matter.

It should be noted, however, that several circumstances favor the view that the text records the death of the wife of the king. The fifth chapter⁵⁷² of Daniel and Xenophon⁵⁷³ agree that the death of Belshazzar occurred in connection with the actual capture of Babylon. According to the cuneiform account Babylon fell into the hands of

⁵⁶⁷ BA II, opposite p. 248. On p. 247, *ibid.*, Hagen says: "Ich glaube in der That *mâr šarri* sicher erkennen zu können." Delitzsch, *ibid.*, *loc. cit.*, in commenting upon the original text which he examined, says: "Am Anfang von Z. 23 glaube auch ich *TUR* noch deutlich zu erkennen, vorher aber stand wohl noch ein ganz schmales Zeichen wie *ši* oder *ša*. Das Wahrscheinlichste ist mir *ša* und ich möchte darum, natürlich unter Vorbehalt, vorschlagen zu lesen: *ina muḫ-ḫi ŠA*, d. i., *iššakin* (er ging drauflos, oder viell. besser: er siegte ob) tödtet den Sohn des Königs." Pinches, *The Old Testament in the Light of the Historical Records of Assyria and Babylonia*, p. 417, contributes the following comment: "An earlier explanation was that the doubtful group (of cuneiform signs) stood for 'the wife' of the king, but in this case it would be difficult to explain how it is that the verbal form (which is ideographically written, and may be read either *imât*, 'he dies,' *tamât*, 'she dies,' or *metât*, 'she died') should differ from that used in the case of the king's mother, where *imtât*, the historical tense of the secondary form of the *qal*, is the form used. The use of *imât* for *imât*, 'he died,' would be paralleled by the use of *irab* for *irub*, 'he entered,' in other parts of the inscription."

⁵⁶⁸ BHT pls. XI-XIV. See *ibid.*, pp. 98-123.

⁵⁶⁹ *Ibid.*, pl. XIII, line 23.

⁵⁷⁰ *Ibid.*, p. 122, note on line 23.

⁵⁷¹ *Ibid.*, p. 118.

⁵⁷² Daniel 5: 30.

⁵⁷³ *Cyropaedia* VII, 5, 30.

Gobryas without general resistance on the sixteenth day of the month Tishri. It was after this event that Nabonidus was captured.⁵⁷⁴ Cyrus entered the city a little over two weeks later. If there is any harmony at all between the cuneiform record, the account of Xenophon, and the statement found in the fifth chapter of Daniel, Belshazzar must have been slain at the time Gobryas took possession of Babylon. This being the case, it is not hard to believe that 'the wife of the king,' Belshazzar's mother, died after the entrance of Cyrus into Babylon. Grief on account of the death of her son and the passing of Babylon into foreign hands may have hastened the death of Nabonidus' queen. Like him she was probably advanced in years.⁵⁷⁵ If, as has been shown,⁵⁷⁶ the wife of Nabonidus was Nitocris and if the probability that she was a daughter of Nebuchadrezzar⁵⁷⁷ is taken into account, the lamentation which took place gains new significance. These are considerations which should not be overlooked in an endeavor to determine the original meaning of the *Nabonidus Chronicle*.

2. Data Furnished by the Cyrus Cylinder

Another cuneiform document dealing in a general way with the close of Nabonidus' reign and the establishment of Persian rule in Babylonia is known as the *Cyrus Cylinder*. This is not a circumstantial narrative of events. The text is confined to an exaltation of Cyrus' rôle as champion of the rights of the Babylonian people. The first part of the record is in a very fragmentary condition.⁵⁷⁸ It is possible to determine, however, from the portions of lines which remain that the aim of the chronicler was to make a strong case in favor of Persian intervention in the affairs of Babylonia. The inhabitants of the land are represented as suffering under the tyranny of an impious oppressor, so much so that Marduk, their supreme god, is moved to pity. This induces the deity to select a leader who will save the people from the consequences of their deplorable condition.

⁵⁷⁴ There is no reference to the death of Nabonidus. Berossus states that Cyrus gave Nabonidus Carmania as a place in which he could spend the rest of his life. See Josephus, *Contra Apionem* I, 20.

⁵⁷⁵ See p. 32f.

⁵⁷⁶ See pp. 38ff.

⁵⁷⁷ See pp. 51-63.

⁵⁷⁸ KA p. 2f, line 1-10.

(1) *Cyrus Chosen as Universal Ruler*

^{11b}*Kul-lat ma-ta-a-ta ka-li-ši-na i-ḫi-iṭ ib-ri-e-šu* ¹²*iš-te'-e-ma ma-al-ki i-ša-ru bi-bil lib-bi šá it-ta-ma-aḫ qa-tu-uš-šu* ^m*Ku-ra-aš šar* ^{a1}*An-ša-an it-ta-bi ni-bi-it-su a-na ma-li-ku-tim kul-la-ta nap-ḫar iz-zak-ra šú-[ma-šu]* ¹³ ^{mát}*Ku-ti-i gi-mir. Um-man-man-da ú-ka-an-ni-šá a-na še-pi-šú nišē^{meš} šal-mat qagqadu(-du) šá ú-šá-ak-ši-du qa-ta-a-šu* ¹⁴*i-na ki-it-tim ù mi-ša-ru iš-te-ni'-e-ši-na-a-tim* ^d*Marduk bēlu rabú ta-ru-ú nišē^{meš}-šu ip-še-e-ti šá dam-qa-a-ta ù lib-ba-šú i-šá-ra ḫa-di-iš ip-pa-[al]-li-is* ¹⁵*a-na áli-šú Báb-iláni^{meš} ki a-la-ak-šú iq-bi ú-ša-aš-bi-it-su-ma ḫar-ra-nu Bábili^{ki} ki-ma ib-ri ù tap-pi-e it-tal-la-ka i-da-a-šú.*⁵⁷⁹

^{11b}The totality of all lands he (Marduk) surveyed (and) inspected. ¹²He sought a righteous prince according to his heart's desire who would grasp his hands. Cyrus, the king of Anshan, whose name he uttered, he proclaimed for lordship over everything. ¹³The land of Kutha, the totality of the Umman-Manda he subdued to his feet. The black-headed people, whom he allowed to approach his hands, ¹⁴he was mindful of in truth and righteousness. Marduk, the great lord, the protector of his people, looked joyfully upon his pious deeds and his righteous heart. ¹⁵He decreed his march upon his city, Babylon, and caused him to take the road to Babylon. Like a friend and companion he went by his side.

(2) *Babylon's Submission to Cyrus*

¹⁶*Um-ma-ni-šú rap-šá-a-tim šá ki-ma me-e nâri lá ú-ta-ad-du-ú ni-ba-šú-un kakkē^{meš}-šú-nu ša-an-du-ma i-šá-ad-di-ḫa i-da-a-šú* ¹⁷*ba-lu qab-li ù ta-ḫa-zi ú-še-ri-ba-aš qi-rib Bábili^{ki} ála-šú Báb-iláni^{meš} ki i-ṭi-ir i-na šap-šá-qi* ^m*Nabû-nâ'id šarru lá pa-li-ḫi-šú ú-ma-al-la-a qa-tu-uš-šu* ¹⁸*nišē^{meš} Bábili^{ki} ka-li-šú-nu nap-ḫar* ^{mát}*Šú-me-ri u Akkadⁱ ru-bi-e ù šak-kan-nak-ka šá-pal-šú ik-mi-sa ú-na-aš-ši-qu še-pu-uš-šú iḫ-du-ú a-na šarru-ú-ti-šú im-mi-ru pa-nu-uš-šu-un* ¹⁹*be-lu šá i-na tu-kul-ti-šá ú-bal-li-ṭu mi-tu-ta-an i-na bu-ta-qu ù pa-ki-e ig-mi-lu kul-la-ta-an ṭa-bi-iš ik-ta-ar-ra-bu-šú iš-tam-ma-ru zi-ki-ir-šú.*⁵⁸⁰

¹⁶His widespread troops, whose number like the waters of a river is not known, put on their weapons and advanced at his side. ¹⁷Without encounter and battle he caused him to enter into the midst of Babylon, his city. He saved Babylon from need. Nabonidus, the king who did not venerate him (Marduk) he (Marduk) delivered into his hands (*i.e.* the hands of Cyrus).

⁵⁷⁹ KA pp. 2-5.

⁵⁸⁰ KA p. 4f.